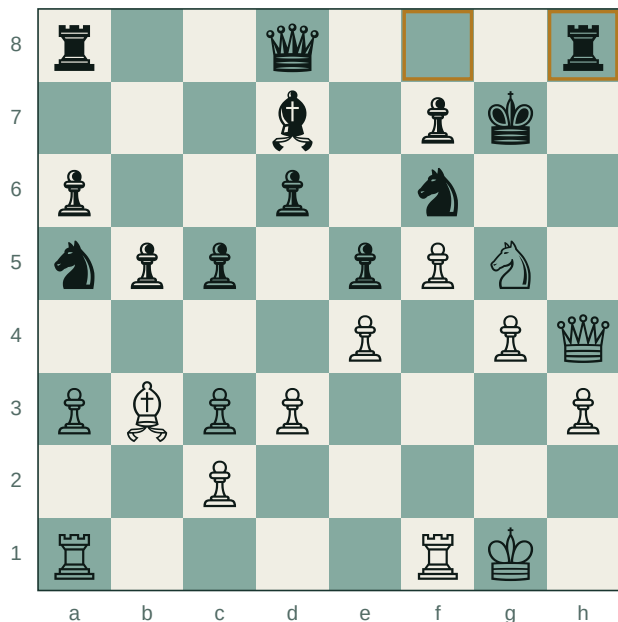


Clearance tactics: White, move 20

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 19...Rh8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20. Ne6+ Bxe6 21. Qg5+ Kf8 22. fxe6

20.Ne6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From e6 it attacks king on g7 and queen on d8. Recorded reply: **20...Bxe6**.

21.Qg5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From g5 it attacks king on g7 and knight on f6. Recorded reply: **21...Kf8**.

22.fxe6 The pawn captures the bishop on e6. The changed line means the rook on f1 attacks the knight on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 30 / Black 31 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.